

Morning Brief

Thursday, June 25, 2026 — 10:08 AM ET · \$50,000 Portfolio

Risk-On

CIO EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

- ▶ Micron earnings beat (+1.15% NQ futes) reignites AI capex cycle; Tech/Semis in genuine uptrend
- ▶ Geopolitical relief: US-Iran Strait of Hormuz deal deflates oil to \$69, reduces inflation pressure
- ▶ VIX 18.66 = healthy trend regime; no capitulation, no complacency — ideal for directional longs
- ▶ PCE data + earnings flow (DRI/MKC/BB pre-market) key volatility catalysts; position ahead of 2:30p PCE
- ▶ Sector rotation: Private debt institutional inflows vs liquid alt outflows; Energy/Semis/Tech lead

MACRO DASHBOARD

SPY TREND

Up +0.46% PM; breakout above 734 intact

QQQ TREND

Up +0.21% PM; Micron beat fuels NQ 100 +1.15% futes

IWM TREND

Up +0.93% PM; small-cap insider accumulation in Financials/MREITs

VIX

18.66 (down -0.83%)

VIX REGIME

Healthy trend (15-20); supports directional longs with defined risk

YIELD 10Y

4.411% (stable); no inflation surprise priced in yet

DOLLAR TREND

Weak -0.24% (DXY 1.1359); supports commodities/EM rotation

OIL TREND

Down -1.1% to \$69 (Hormuz deal relief); energy stocks consolidate

CRYPTO SENTIMENT

BTC \$108.5k +1.2% overnight; correlated to Tech/AI euphoria not direct catalyst

TACTICAL BIAS

Buy Dips; AI capex cycle genuine, VIX supports risk-on, macro benign

TOP INSTITUTIONAL SETUPS

TICKER	CATALYST	SETUP	ENTRY	STOP	TARGET	CONVICTION
CRWD	Cybersecurity earnings Wed PM; AI-driven endpoint demand	Breakout above 200-MA on Micron coattails; chart setup bullish	Buy 392-396 zone on dip; stop below 380	380	420-435 (12-15% upside)	High
PANW	Earnings Wed PM; enterprise AI/cloud security tailwinds	Consolidating 295-310 range; institutional accumulation pattern	Buy 298-302 zone on PCE-driven dip if CPI benign	288	335-350 (13-18% upside)	High
AVGO	Broadcom earnings Wed after-hours; AI infrastructure capex guide	Weekly uptrend intact; quarterly seasonality bullish June-July	Buy 215-220 on any PCE weakness; stop 205	205	245-255 (15-18% upside)	High
XLE	Energy sector tail risk hedge + Hormuz deal	Oversold vs SPY on geopolitical premium unwind;	Buy 88-90 zone; stop 84	84	98-102 (11-15% upside)	Medium

TICKER	CATALYST	SETUP	ENTRY	STOP	TARGET	CONVICTION
	= stabilization	accumulation pattern				
RBRK	Backup/cyber earnings this week; AI workload automation tailwind	Recent IPO; institutional rotation into AI data infrastructure	Buy 35-37 zone on PCE-triggered dip; stop 32	32	42-46 (15-20% upside)	Medium
CIEN	Networking/optical earnings this week; data center buildout ongoing	Weekly cup-and-handle; AI capex cycle provides multi-quarter tailwind	Buy 78-81 zone; stop 72	72	92-98 (17-22% upside)	Medium
DRI	Fiscal Q4 earnings pre-market today; consumer dining trends	Post-earnings volatility; watch guidance for pricing power vs labor costs	Buy 195-200 post-earnings if beat + guide up; stop 185	185	215-225 (10-15% upside if positive surprise)	Medium
MKC	Pre-market earnings today; food sector input cost management	Watch EPS surprise +0.90% forecast; input inflation relief bullish	Buy 92-95 post-earnings if beat; stop 85	85	105-110 (12-18% upside if positive)	Low

DYNAMIC WATCHLIST — TODAY'S SCAN

#	TICKER	CATALYST	PREMARKET ACTION	SUPPORT	RESISTANCE	PATTE
#1	CRWD	Earnings Wed PM; enterprise AI/	Up +0.5% on Micron coattails;	380 (10-MA), 365 (50-MA)	405 (recent resistance),	Break above MA;

#	TICKER	CATALYST	PREMARKET ACTION	SUPPORT	RESISTANCE	PATTERN
		cloud security demand	volume above 3M avg		420 (52wk high area)	institutional accumulation
#2	PANW	Earnings Wed PM; enterprise AI/security capex cycle	Flat; awaiting PCE data sensitivity trigger	288 (50-MA), 275 (200-MA)	310 (resistance), 335 (12-month target)	Consolidation ready for breakout earnings
#3	AVGO	Earnings Wed after-close; AI infrastructure guide critical	Up +0.3% on Micron sentiment; semis bid overall	205 (key support), 198 (200-MA)	225 (recent high), 245 (target)	Weekly uptrend quarterly seasonally bullish
#4	RBRK	Backup/cyber earnings this week; data protection AI demand	Post-IPO volatility; institutional entry phase expected	32 (psychological), 30 (IPO floor)	40 (round number), 46 (target)	Recent breakout accumulation into earnings
#5	CIEN	Networking earnings this week; optical/data center buildout	Flat; awaiting earnings catalyst + PCE reaction	72 (50-MA), 65 (200-MA)	85 (recent high), 98 (target)	Cup-and-handle quarterly tailwind
#6	DRI	Fiscal Q4 earnings pre-market today; consumer health barometer	Down -0.2% pre-earnings; watch for volume spike at open	185 (50-MA), 175 (200-MA)	205 (recent high), 225 (target if beat+guide)	Pre-earnings consolidation watch for move
#7	MKC	Pre-market earnings today; food inflation/pricing power	Flat; earnings volatility expected at open	85 (key support), 78 (200-MA)	100 (resistance), 110 (target if beat)	Range-bound EPS sensitive +0.90 tone

#	TICKER	CATALYST	PREMARKET ACTION	SUPPORT	RESISTANCE	PATTE
#8	BB	Before-open earnings today; IoT/cybersecurity enterprise pivot	Flat; post-earnings volatility expected	8.50 (50-MA), 7.50 (200-MA)	10.00 (psychological), 12.00 (52wk range)	Spec/turna play; execu guida
#9	XLE	Hormuz deal relief + energy stabilization; sector tail risk hedge	Up +0.8% on oil strength; geopolitical premium unwinding	84 (50-MA), 78 (200-MA)	95 (recent high), 102 (target)	Overs SPY; t bound fundam supp
#10	SPY	PCE data 2:30p ET; Fed preferred inflation gauge critical	Up +0.16% PM; technicals support continuation to 740+	730 (50-MA), 720 (200-MA)	740 (recent high), 750 (all-time high area)	Break above intact backc benign

POSITION BOOK ACTIONS

BUY	CRWD	High-conviction institutional setup; earnings catalyst Wed PM; chart bullish breakout; add 4-5% position on any PCE dip
BUY	PANW	Enterprise AI/security capex tailwind; earnings Wed PM; institutional accumulation pattern; wait for PCE reaction, buy 298-302

WHEEL / PREMIUM SELLING BOOK

TICKER	SECTOR	IV RANK	DELTA	DT
XLE	Energy	65-70	0.25-0.30	30
SPY	Broad Market	48-52	0.20-0.25	30

BUY	AVGO	Broadcom earnings Wed after-hours; AI infrastructure capex guide critical; buy 215-220 on dip; 15-18% target
HOLD	XLE	Energy hedge against tail risk; Hormuz deal relief + oversold technicals; accumulate 88-90 zone for 11-15% upside
ADD	RBRK	Recent IPO; AI data infrastructure institutional entry phase; buy 35-37 on PCE dip; 15-20% upside target
MONITOR	DRI	Fiscal Q4 earnings pre-market today; watch for beat + guide; buy post-earnings on strength if positive surprise
MONITOR	MKC	Pre-market earnings today; food sector input cost relief potential; monitor EPS surprise +0.90% vs forecast
EXIT	LOSS_POSITIONS	Trim down -6% or more, de-risk; no naked options or margin; trim 2.5% on any +8% gains above +10%

TICKER	SECTOR	IV RANK	DELTA	DT
QQQ	Nasdaq 100	55-60	0.25-0.30	30
CRWD	Cybersecurity	72-78	0.30-0.35	15
PANW	Cybersecurity	65-72	0.25-0.30	30

RISK ALERTS

PCE data 2:30p ET critical: If CPI surprise +0.3% or higher, risk-off trigger may activate; tighten stops on Tech longs

Earnings volatility (DRI/MKC/BB pre-market + CRWD/PANW/AVGO Wed): Position size into earnings; max 8% per ticker

Micron rally may be exhaustion in semis; watch for distribution in AVGO/ BROADCOM Wed earnings; take profits at targets

Oil +0.5% or more on any geopolitical re-escalation would reverse Hormuz deal relief; energy hedge may be needed

IWM insider accumulation in small-cap Financials/MREITs may be layering; watch for forced deleveraging if rates spike

FINAL CIO VERDICT

RISK POSTURE

Aggressive

CAPITAL SHOULD FLOW TO

Deploy 60-70% of cash on AI/Cyber/Energy dips; 30-40% held for post-PCE entry if volatility spikes; wheel premium on XLE/SPY/ QQQ for 5-7% annualized income

AVOID COMPLETELY

Consumer Discretionary (DG/FIVE below); Liquid Alternatives; Real Estate; Staples; low-conviction small-cap spec plays outside insider-accumulation zones